Fair Use of NOAA's CDR Data Sets, Algorithms and Documentation:

The development of a Climate Data Record (CDR) - including computer algorithms, data sets and documentation - is typically a painstaking process involving multiple scientists working over many years. These scientists rely on the fair use and proper acknowledgment of the CDR to sustain their professional reputations and careers.

The National Academy of Sciences has issued guidance for credit allocation in scientific work [1]. The CDR Program urges anyone using a NOAA CDR to honor this guidance by properly recognizing the CDR scientist and CDR Program following the acknowledgement and citation examples below. In cases where a NOAA CDR becomes a fundamental part of a study, publication, presentation or proposal, the CDR Program encourages users to offer co-authorship status to the original CDR developers. If the data are used we encourage the use of the data citation to ensure data provenance and attribution [2].

Acknowledgement Example: The Outgoing Longwave Radiation - Daily CDR used in this study was acquired from NOAA's National Centers for Environmental Information (http://www.ncei.noaa.gov). This CDR was originally developed by Hai-Tien Lee and colleagues for NOAA's CDR Program.

Literature Citation Example: Schreck, C. J., H.-T. Lee, and K. R. Knapp, 2018: HIRS Outgoing Longwave Radiation—Daily Climate Data Record: Application toward Identifying Tropical Subseasonal Variability. Remote Sensing, 10, 1325, doi:10.3390/rs10091325.

Data Citation Example: Hai-Tien Lee, University of Maryland (2025): NOAA Climate Data Record (CDR) of Outgoing Longwave Radiation – Daily. [indicate subset used]. NOAA National Centers for Environmental Information. https://doi.org/10.25921/9pt5-by77

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“Register” for any product of interest on the CDR website [5]; registration enables the CDR Program to provide announcements of product status, changes and updates, and provides a pathway for optional user feedback on product quality, existing applications and emerging uses of the data.

[1] On Being a Scientist: A Guide to Responsible Conduct in Research: 3rd Edition (2009), Committee on Science, Engineering, and Public Policy, National Academy of Sciences, National Academy of Engineering, and Institute of Medicine, 82 pages, ISBN-10: 0-309-11970-7. Available for download at: http://www.nap.edu/catalog.php?record_id=12192.
[2] Ruth E. Duerr, Robert R. Downs, Curt Tilmes, Bruce Barkstrom, W. Christopher Lenhardt, Joseph Glassy, Luis E. Bermudez and Peter Slaughter. On the utility of identification schemes for digital earth science data: an assessment and recommendations, Earth Science Informatics, Vol. 4, Num. 3, 139-160, 2011, doi:10.1007/s12145-011-0083-6.
[3] https://obamawhitehouse.archives.gov/sites/default/files/omb/memoranda/2013/m-13-13.pdf
[4] https://obamawhitehouse.archives.gov/the-press-office/2013/05/09/executive-order-making-open-and-machine-readable-new-default-government-
[5] https://www.ncei.noaa.gov/products/climate-data-records